

Emergency Vet Cost Planning Checklist

Prepare the money, records, and decisions before an urgent visit happens.

Emergency contacts

- ☐ Nearest 24-hour emergency hospital: name, phone, address, and driving time.
- ☐ Backup emergency hospital if the first clinic is full.
- ☐ Primary veterinarian phone number and after-hours instructions.
- ☐ Poison control phone number and your pet insurance claim contact.

Payment and insurance readiness

- ☐ Know whether the clinic requires payment at checkout.
- ☐ Save a credit card, emergency fund, or financing option for upfront payment.
- ☐ Write down your deductible, reimbursement rate, annual limit, and waiting periods.
- ☐ Keep policy number, provider login, and claim submission steps easy to find.

What to bring

- ☐ Medication names, doses, and timing.
- ☐ Medical records, vaccine records, and recent lab results if available.
- ☐ Product label, plant photo, food package, or toxin package if exposure is possible.
- ☐ Timeline: when signs started, what changed, what your pet ate, and any first-aid steps already taken.

Emergency rule

Do not wait for severe symptoms after toxin exposure, inability to urinate, breathing trouble, collapse, seizure, major trauma, repeated vomiting, or pale gums. Call a veterinarian or emergency clinic.